However, the Chinese do not necessarily stick to this principle. There are instances where the Chinese, after agreeing to a common position either orally or even sometimes in the form of a joint statement, will still add on something in their public pronouncements, or give their own interpretation to the language in the agreed text, that may cause problems for the other side. They bank on the fear of public questioning in democratic states about an agreement coming unravelled, to deter the opposite side from taking issue in public with a Chinese statement that has not followed the commonly agreed position arrived at by the negotiators. This is a risk for democratic states and has to be built into the scenario.

Although perception management is important to all governments, the Chinese have skilfully woven the concept of 'face' (*mianzi* or *lian* in Chinese) into the negotiation. 'Face' is a subtle tool to ensure that a negotiation does not result in the loss of perceived superiority or give the appearance of the other party visibly gaining advantage at the expense of China. It is axiomatic when negotiating with China to talk about giving them 'face'; however, there is never any question of the Chinese giving 'face' to anybody else. The concept has gained such currency that it is leveraged by the Chinese to extract almost any concession from the other side. The other side almost becomes a co-conspirator in the face-giving exercise, as if it is 'our little secret'.

Indian negotiators should ignore any suggestions about giving face to the Chinese by making it clear that both sides enter a negotiation to secure their interests and if that is the case, there is no need to give additional 'face' to anybody. Another perception management skill that the Chinese side exploits to great effect both before and after negotiations is by leaking stories that provide ammunition to the political opposition in the opposite party's country, which acts as an